

Privacy Notice and Data Protection Policy

ICO Registration Number: ZB846962

How will my data be processed and stored?

In May 2018, the UK introduced the General Data Protection Regulation (UK GDPR) alongside the Data Protection Act 2018. These laws govern how personal information is collected, stored and used. I am registered with the Information Commissioner's Office (ICO).

These regulations ensure that your personal, confidential and, in some cases, sensitive information is held securely and processed fairly and lawfully. This includes identifiable information such as your name, contact details, reasons for seeking therapy, session records, text messages and emails between Katie Hewitt and yourself.

What is my lawful basis for processing your information?

Under UK GDPR, I process your personal information under the following lawful bases:

- Contract – to provide the therapeutic services you have requested.
- Legitimate Interests – to maintain client records, ensure continuity of care and manage my professional practice effectively.
- Legal Obligation – where I am required by law to share information, such as safeguarding concerns, court orders or legal requests.

Some of the information I collect may include health-related information, which is classed as Special Category Data under UK GDPR. This information is processed only where necessary for the provision of therapeutic support and in accordance with the requirements of UK data protection law.

How long will you hold my information for?

As a member of the Association for Solution Focused Hypnotherapy (AfSFH), I am bound by their regulations regarding data retention.

I must retain your information for 8 years after your final session.

For children, records must be retained until their 25th birthday. If treatment ends when the child is 17 years old, records will be retained until their 26th birthday.

Client records will then be securely destroyed in the January following these dates, in accordance with professional, insurance and legal requirements.

What if I would like my data to be destroyed before this date?

Due to the sensitive nature of my work, professional insurance requirements and potential legal obligations, client records cannot usually be deleted before the minimum retention period has expired.

You may request erasure of your data; however, this right is not absolute and may not apply where records must be retained for legal, safeguarding, insurance or professional reasons.

Am I able to see or get a copy of the information held by you?

Yes.

Under UK GDPR, you have the right to request access to the personal information I hold about you.

To do so, please send a written request specifying the information you would like to access. I will provide a copy of your information within one calendar month of receiving your request and confirming your identity.

There is normally no charge for this service.

Please note that my professional indemnity insurer or legal advisers may review information before disclosure if required.

What are your reasons for collecting this information?

I collect the following information to provide the highest quality support to my clients:

- Your goals and what you aim to achieve from sessions
- A small amount of relevant medical information
- Brief session notes
- Your contact details
- GP contact details (where appropriate)
- Basic information about significant people in your life

This information helps ensure continuity within sessions and supports your progress towards your goals. It allows me to refer back to previous discussions and information from earlier sessions.

Your contact and GP details will only be used where appropriate and with your knowledge and consent, unless there is a legal or safeguarding reason to do otherwise.

How do I know that Katie Hewitt will store my information safely?

I take reasonable steps to protect your personal information and maintain its confidentiality.

Paper Records

- Stored in a locked filing cabinet within a secure building.

Text Messages

- My work phone is password protected.

Email

- My email account is protected by a strong password and two-step verification.

Electronic Records

- Electronic devices used for business purposes are password protected and kept secure.
- Where cloud-based services are used, they are protected by appropriate security measures and authentication processes.

Who may my information be shared with?

Your information will remain confidential unless there is a legitimate reason for disclosure.

Information may be shared with:

- My professional clinical supervisor (anonymised wherever possible)
- My professional indemnity insurer
- Legal advisers where necessary
- Safeguarding agencies or social care services
- Emergency services where there is a serious risk of harm
- Courts, police or regulatory bodies where legally required

Information will only be shared where necessary, proportionate and lawful.

Are our discussions within sessions confidential?

Everything you share with me during sessions remains confidential.

Occasionally, I may discuss aspects of my work with my clinical supervisor to ensure I am providing the most effective support possible. Wherever possible, identifying information will be removed before these discussions take place.

My supervisor is also bound by professional confidentiality and data protection requirements.

Working with Child Clients

When working with children, confidentiality is a key part of building a safe and trusting therapeutic relationship.

What your child shares in sessions will generally be kept private, helping them feel secure and able to talk openly. However, I will keep parents or carers informed about general progress, themes we are working on and strategies that may help support their child outside of sessions.

I will not share specific details discussed by your child unless:

- They give permission for me to do so; or
- I have a safeguarding concern; or
- I am legally required to disclose information.

Wherever possible, I will discuss any necessary disclosures with the child and involve parents or carers appropriately.

My aim is to work in partnership with families while respecting the child's need for a confidential and safe therapeutic space.

Safeguarding Exceptions

The main exceptions to confidentiality arise where there is a safeguarding concern or a legal requirement to disclose information.

As a therapist, I have a duty of care towards my clients. If I believe there is a risk of serious harm to yourself or another person, I may need to share relevant information with appropriate agencies or professionals.

Where possible, I will discuss any concerns with you before taking action.

I may also be required to provide information where requested under a court order, warrant or other legal obligation.

For further information, please request a copy of my Safeguarding Policy.

What if I see Katie Hewitt outside of a session?

Your confidentiality will always be respected.

If we meet outside of a session, I may acknowledge you, but it is entirely your choice whether or not to engage in conversation. I will never identify you as a client or discuss any aspect of our work together.

Third-Party Service Providers and International Data Transfers

To support the running of my practice, I use a number of trusted third-party service providers. These may process limited amounts of your personal information on my behalf.

These include:

- Gmail (Google) – for email communication and secure storage of emails.
- Outlook/Hotmail (Microsoft) – for email communication and business administration.

- WhatsApp – for appointment reminders and communication where agreed.
- Zoom – for online therapy sessions where applicable.
- TidyCal – for appointment scheduling and booking management.

Some of these providers may process data outside of the United Kingdom. Where this occurs, they use recognised safeguards and security measures designed to protect personal information in accordance with UK GDPR requirements.

I only use providers that I believe take data protection and security seriously and that offer appropriate safeguards for personal information.

Please avoid sending highly sensitive personal or clinical information via WhatsApp where possible.

Online sessions conducted via Zoom are not recorded unless specifically agreed in advance.

What happens if there is a data breach?

Whilst every effort is made to keep your information secure, no system can ever be completely risk-free.

If I become aware of a personal data breach that is likely to result in a risk to your rights and freedoms, I will follow the Information Commissioner's Office (ICO) reporting requirements and notify affected individuals where required by law.

I will take all reasonable steps to investigate, contain and minimise the impact of any breach.

Your Data Protection Rights

Under UK GDPR, you have the right to:

- Access the personal information I hold about you.
- Request correction of inaccurate or incomplete information.
- Request restriction of processing in certain circumstances.
- Object to processing where applicable.
- Request transfer of your data where applicable.
- Lodge a complaint with the Information Commissioner's Office (ICO). Please find a copy of the complaint form on my website.

Please note that some rights may be limited where information must be retained for legal, safeguarding, insurance or professional reasons.

Who is the Data Controller?

The Data Controller is:

Katie Hewitt
37 Sunnyside Road
Clevedon
BS21 7TL

Contact Information

Katie Hewitt
Telephone: 07834 185794
Email: katiesianholistics@gmail.com

If you have any concerns about how your information is handled, please contact me in the first instance.

You also have the right to complain to the Information Commissioner's Office (ICO):

Information Commissioner's Office
Wycliffe House
Water Lane
Wilmslow
Cheshire
SK9 5AF

Telephone: 0303 123 1113

Website: www.ico.org.uk

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Last Reviewed: June 2026

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